

pause on the training of AI systems more powerful than OpenAI's GPT-4. Speaking to the press, Mustafa Suleyman, the cofounder of Google DeepMind and now the CEO of startup Inflection AI, said that, while he disagreed with those seeking a pause on next generation AI systems, the industry may have to consider that course of action sometime soon. "I do not think there is any evidence today that frontier models of the size of GPT-4 present any significant catastrophic harms, let alone any existential harms. It is objectively clear that there is incredible value to people in the world. But it is a very sensible question to ask, as we create models which are 10 times larger, 100 times larger, 1000 times larger, which is going to happen over the next three or four years," he said.

Industry attendees had also remarked in social media about the evergreen debate of open source versus closed-source approaches to AI research. While some felt that it was too risky to freely distribute the source code of powerful AI models, the open source community argued that open sourcing the models will help speed up and intensify safety research rather than the code being within the realms of profit-driven companies.

It is interesting to note that the event happened at Bletchley Park, a stately mansion near London, which was once the secret home of the 'code-breakers,' including Alan Turing, who helped the Allied Forces defeat the Nazis during the second world war by cracking the German *Enigma* code. Symbolically, it is hoped that the summit will result in a strong collaboration between nations aiming to build effective guardrails for the proper use of AI. However, some cynics remind us that the code-breakers team later evolved into UK's most powerful in-

What is happening at OpenAI: The Sam Altman Files

Even as this issue is about to go to press, there is a series of breaking news about Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI. On November 17th, OpenAI announced that Sam Altman would be leaving the board, and that current CTO Mira Murati would take over as interim CEO. The official statement alleged that Altman was "not consistently candid in his communications with the board, hindering its ability to exercise its responsibilities," and that, "the board no longer has confidence in his ability to continue leading OpenAI."

Speculation is rife that there have been several disagreements within the board and amongst senior employees of OpenAI, over safe and responsible development of AI tech, and whether the business motives of the company were clashing swords with the non-profit ideals. Readers might recall that this is not the first time the OpenAI board has had a fallout over safety-related concerns.

Unhappy with the sacking of Altman, co-founder Greg Brockman and three senior scientists also resigned. A majority of OpenAI's employees also protested against the board's move. When Murati too reacted in favour of Altman, the OpenAI board replaced her with Emmett Shear, former CEO of Twitch, as the interim CEO. Soon thereafter, Microsoft announced that Altman and Brockman would be joining Microsoft and leading a new advanced AI research team. It looked like the entire company against the board. On November 22nd, five days after the original statement, it came to be known that Altman would be reinstated as CEO of OpenAI, and would work under the supervision of a newly-constituted board.

The soup sure is boiling, and we will be ready to serve you more news on this in the subsequent issues.

telligence agency, which, in cahoots with the US, spied on the rest of the world!

Regulations are rife, yet innovation thrives

The idea behind these regulatory efforts is not to dampen the growth of AI—because everyone realises that AI can play a very constructive role in this world. As a simple example, take AI4Bharat, a government-backed initiative at IIT Madras, which develops open source datasets, tools, models, and applications for Indian languages. Microsoft Jugalbandi is a generative AI chatbot for government assistance, powered by AI4Bharat. Local users can ask the chatbot a question in their own language—either voice or text—and get a response in the same language. The chatbot retrieves relevant content, usually in English, and translates it into the local language for the user. The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) is working with AI4Bharat to facilitate voice-based merchant payments and peer-to-peer transactions in local Indian languages. This one example is enough to show the role of AI in

bridging the digital divide. But there is more if you wish to know.

Karya, a Bengaluru-based startup founded by Stanford-alumnus Manu Chopra, focuses on sourcing, annotating, and labelling non-English data, with high accuracy. The 2021 startup, which predates the ChatGPT buzz, promises its clients high-quality local-language content, eliminating bias, discrimination, and misinformation at the data level. AI services trained using only English content often tend to have an improper view of other cultures. In a media story, Stanford University professor Mehran Sahami explained that it is critical to have a broad representation of training data, including non-English data, so AI systems do not perpetuate harmful stereotypes, produce hate speech, or yield misinformation. Karya attempts to bridge this gap by collecting content in a wide range of Indian languages. The startup achieves this by employing workers, especially women, from rural areas. Their app allows workers to enter content even without Internet access and provides voice support for those with limited literacy. Supported by grants,